

LISTENING

#29

1 – Listen to a technology report about London buses possibly being powered by coffee waste. Pay attention to why coffee is used, who is behind the project, and what environmental benefits are mentioned.

Coffee-Powered Buses

1 - What product is being considered as a fuel for London buses?

2 - Why is coffee considered a good option for biofuel?

- a) It is cheap to grow
- b) It produces a lot of waste
- c) It gives buses more speed

3 - What environmental issue is mentioned as a big problem in London?

4 - What is the name of the company working on this idea?

- a) Biobus
- b) Biobean
- c) Bioenergy

5 - What has the entrepreneur already done with coffee chains?

- a) Signed deals to collect waste
- b) Opened new coffee shops
- c) Replaced petrol stations

6 - When will more information about the bus project be revealed?

7 - According to Biobean, using all the UK's coffee waste could power a city the size of:

- a) London
- b) Manchester
- c) Birmingham

8 - Why are biofuels made from waste preferred over biofuels made from crops?

- a) Waste-based fuels smell better
- b) Crops should be used to feed people
- c) Crops are too expensive

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

London Buses Try Coffee-Based Fuel to Cut Emissions

London is known for its iconic red buses, but soon they might have a surprising new fuel source: used coffee grounds. A British clean-energy company has developed a biofuel using coffee waste collected from cafes and restaurants around the city. The goal is to reduce dependence on fossil fuels and help tackle London's air pollution problem, which remains one of the worst in Europe.

Every year, millions of cups of coffee are enjoyed in the UK, creating huge amounts of leftover grounds. Until now, most of this waste was simply thrown away. By turning it into fuel, companies hope to give the waste a new purpose while supporting sustainability.

The company behind the innovation says that its coffee-based biofuel can be blended with traditional diesel and used without modifying bus engines. If implemented on a large scale, it could significantly cut carbon emissions. The fuel also has another advantage: unlike earlier biofuels made from crops such as corn, this process does not require farmland or food resources.

Environmental experts say that this kind of creative recycling could help cities move toward greener public transportation. The challenge will be collecting enough waste to keep buses running consistently. Still, supporters believe that combining different clean-energy sources — including electricity, hydrogen, and waste-based fuels — will play an important role in the fight against climate change.

If these coffee-powered buses become a success, passengers might enjoy knowing that their morning espresso is helping the city breathe a little easier.

Retrieved from: <https://www.theguardian.com/environment/2017/nov/20/london-buses-coffee-waste-biofuel>

Comprehension Questions

1. What problem is this new biofuel trying to help solve?

2. What happens to most coffee waste before this project?

3. Why is coffee-based fuel better than earlier crop-based biofuels?

4. Which other clean-energy sources are mentioned as part of the future of transport?

5. If coffee-powered buses became common, do you think passengers should pay *less*, *more*, or the *same* for tickets? Why?
